

Tuesday, June 30, 2026

The Day Forward Felt Natural



I didn't notice when Day 6.5 turned into Day 7.

Maybe that's what happens when life finally becomes busy with living again.

I was still working on my training. Lead magnets. Social media posts. The usual. But somewhere between 1:55 AM and 5:33 AM, I realized I wasn't working because I was distracting myself. I was working because I was capable of working again.



5:33 AM — I finished everything.

Five social media posts. One lead magnet. One lead magnet teaser. And a few Loom videos for a mock founder meeting exercise. A week ago, my brain was too heavy to focus on anything. Tonight, I spent hours thinking about headlines, visuals, and how to communicate value.

Different kind of storytelling. Still storytelling.



6:18 AM — Everything's done.

Now I'm just waiting for 7 AM so I can officially log off. And right now, I'm very sleepy. Doing nothing. Hahahahah.

I caught myself thinking about the difference. A week ago, exhaustion came from carrying too much inside my heart. Tonight, it came from doing honest work.

I know which one I'd rather carry.



7:00 AM — Shift over.

And I'm sooooo sleepy. Not emotionally exhausted. Not mentally drained. Just sleepy. There's something comforting about that. A week ago, I stayed awake because my mind wouldn't stop thinking. Today, I'm struggling to stay awake because I actually worked.

The commute today was about ten steps — from my desk to my bed.



11:53 AM — Just woke up.

I think I made a decision about the journal. Day 7 doesn't need a .5. Today doesn't feel like it needs another chapter. It's just today. So I'll keep writing until 11:59 PM. One page. One day. The way ordinary days are probably supposed to be.

I guess that's another sign things are changing. Not every day needs to be a milestone. Some days are allowed to simply exist.

I checked my phone. The first thing I noticed was a message from Dewy.

"Join ako dyan later hahaha slr kuya bagsak na kagabi."

I replied, *"Haha slr din. Ako naman bagsak na and kakagising lang."*

Funny how "bagsak" means different things depending on who's saying it. She stayed up gaming. I stayed up working. Different worlds, same exhaustion.

Then I doom scrolled Facebook for a bit. Nothing spectacular. Just waking myself up. Fixed my bed. Cleaned myself up. And now I'm sitting in front of my PC.

In a while I'll go to the kitchen and cook some rice. I think I want luncheon meat for brunch. Then I'll continue watching my K-drama. Maybe join Discord voice and catch up with friends.

I'm still invisible on all my chat platforms. But maybe soon I'll change my status to Active. And if someone comes along who deserves my full attention... I'll set it to Do Not Disturb.



I walked to the kitchen and opened YouTube without thinking. The first song I searched for was Sparkle by RADWIMPS.

I think it's officially my favorite song now.

A week ago, I listened to it because it reminded me of someone. Today, I listened to it because it simply felt like home. Funny how music changes with us.

After it ended, I didn't choose another song. I just let YouTube decide.

And somehow, it knew.

One after another, songs I actually wanted to hear started playing. It felt like having a friend quietly holding the AUX cord. No arguments. No skips. Just... *"I got you."*

I smiled.

"Wow, YouTube. In my place."

Then it played How Many Hours by Michael Learns to Rock.

I just laughed. YouTube really knew my vibe today.

I started cooking rice while the playlist kept going. There's something peaceful about cooking while music fills the kitchen. No dramatic thoughts. No overthinking. Just me, waiting for the rice cooker to click.



12:53 PM — After the music finished, I stopped and watched my K-drama while the luncheon meat cooked in the air fryer and the rice cooked itself.

The weather is still cool from all the rain. Honestly, I like this kind of weather. The house feels calmer. The coffee lasts a little longer.

I remembered the carrot cutter my uncle's secretary asked me to redesign.

It can wait. Hahaha.



1:35 PM — Done eating. Made some coffee to go with it.

Now all I have to do is binge watch the show. No dishes. No work. No training until tonight. No deadlines breathing down my neck. Just a hot cup of coffee, a good K-drama, and the rest of the afternoon.

I think...

I earned this.

Not long ago, I'd probably feel guilty for spending hours doing nothing productive. Today, I don't. Because rest isn't wasting time. Rest is part of the work too. Especially after the kind of week I've had.



2:20 PM — I've been binge-watching The Legend of Kitchen Soldier all afternoon.

Then a scene came up. Nothing romantic. Just a mother. A grandmother.

And for some reason, my chest tightened.

I've noticed this happens a lot. Whenever a story revolves around someone's mom or grandma, my heart quietly aches. Maybe it's because of the regrets I still carry. I wasn't there when they passed away. That's a sentence I've learned to say. But I don't think I've ever truly accepted it.

For the past week, I've been so focused on filling the emptiness inside me. Writing. Talking. Healing. Learning how to move forward. And it has helped. It really has.

But while watching that scene today, I realized something. Not every empty space is supposed to be filled. Some holes don't exist because something is missing today. They exist because someone was once there. My mom. My grandmother. They're not spaces waiting for replacements. They're spaces shaped exactly like them. Nothing else will ever fit there.

And maybe that's okay.



A few episodes later, the show got me again.

This time, for a completely different reason.

There was this scene where one of the characters finally got to see his late grandmother again because of a hamburger the protagonist cooked for him. At first, I actually felt my eyes getting watery. The scene was beautiful. You could feel how much he missed her.

Then, out of absolutely nowhere, his grandmother's face slowly transformed into the protagonist's face.

I wasn't ready.

I completely lost it.

HAHAHAHAHAHAHAHA.

I laughed so hard I almost forgot I was tearing up just a few seconds earlier. Whoever wrote this show knew exactly what they were doing. They gave you enough time to feel the sadness... then slapped you with the funniest visual possible.

Maybe that's why I'm enjoying this K-drama so much. It doesn't pretend life is only happy. Or only sad. Sometimes you're remembering someone you love. Then five seconds later, you're laughing because grandma suddenly has someone else's face.

Life does that too.

Maybe healing looks a little like that. Not choosing between sadness or happiness. But allowing yourself to experience both when they come.



3:38 PM — A few more episodes later, I got hungry again.

Apparently, binge-watching burns calories. Or maybe it just gives me an excuse to keep visiting the kitchen. I just warmed up some corned beef, grabbed another plate of rice, and went straight back in front of the TV.

Simple food. Simple afternoon. Exactly the kind of day I've been having.



I wrote something today.

Lyrics. A song.

We used to talk every day

Now your name just fades away

Funny how a stranger knows

More than me these days

I kept writing until it became a whole song. I'm not sure if it's good. But it says what I needed to say.

I want to learn it on the guitar. Not to intensify the sadness. But for the words to get out of my chest. When you write, the feelings leave your head and become words. When you play guitar and sing, those same feelings leave your chest and become music.

I think that's a healthy reason to learn a song.



The rain came back. Again.

I wasn't really paying attention to whether it was sunny or gloomy anymore. But somehow, NoThingz found its way into my speakers. It fit. The weather. The coffee. The K-drama. The slow pace of the afternoon.

Sometimes you don't choose music because of how you feel. Sometimes the weather chooses it for you. And today, I didn't mind letting it.

I shared the playlist with Yosh too.



You know, sometimes I'm still doubting myself. One minute I'm okay, doing normal things. And then one minute I'm here, feeling restless.

I don't think that means I'm going backward. I think it just means I'm healing like a human being. Healing isn't a straight line that climbs upward every day. Some days the water is calm. Sometimes a wave comes in unexpectedly. But the overall tide can still be moving out.

The difference now is — when the restlessness shows up, I write. I make coffee. I watch another episode. I message a friend. I pick a song. I keep living.

It still shows up. But it doesn't get to take over my whole day anymore.



I talked to Yosh today.

She asked kamusta. I told her I finally got closure. She asked about Elaine's message. I sent her the link to the Special Chapters.

"Basahin mo, mars."

She read it. Then she said, *"Ang ganda nga pwede na talaga pang book."*

I told her, *"Kaya ko lang nasusulat yan kasi yan ung mga gusto ko sabihin saka mga nangyayari sakin."*

She asked, *"Naluha ka no?"*

"Yes kahit hindi ako broken feeling ko nabroken ako."

I smiled at that.

Then she said something that stayed with me. *"Sana makakita ka ng tulad kong na appreciate lahat."*

I told her I'm not looking. "*Dumating nalang kung dadating.*"

The conversation drifted. We talked about her son Haya — how big he's gotten, how he looks like his dad now. We talked about cassette tapes, rewinding with a ballpen, karaoke minus one. Random things. Friends talking.

I told her I picked up the guitar again. "*Gusto ko tugtugin ung mga songs nya.*"

I don't know how we went from closure to cassette tapes to Haya's love life. But that's how conversations with old friends go. No agenda. No heavy emotions. Just life.



8:00 PM — I looked at the clock.

Still full from the corned beef earlier. I don't think I need dinner. But I'm thinking of making another cup of coffee. Not because I'm sleepy. Not because I need caffeine. I just enjoy having a warm cup beside me.

Maybe it's becoming part of my rhythm now. Coffee. A good show. Some music. Random conversations with friends. Then writing about everything before the day ends.

I don't know if that's healing. Or if this is simply who I am.



Around 8:35 PM, I finally changed something I hadn't touched in days.

My Discord status.

From Invisible... to Active.

It sounds like such a small thing. But I realized I wasn't hiding anymore. Not from my friends. Not from conversations. Not from myself.

I also changed my bio:

"If you can love the wrong one this much, just imagine how beautiful it will feel when the right one shows up. Your capacity to love so deeply shows your strength, not a mistake."

Then I added a note.

Just enjoying ordinary days.

I looked at it for a while. It made me smile. Because for the first time, it wasn't something I wanted people to believe. It was something I actually felt.



9:00 PM — I think I'll create my Day 7 journal now.

My next shift is at 11 PM. But for now, I just want to sit with today.

Nothing dramatic happened today. Nothing life-changing. But I woke up, I cooked, I watched a K-drama, I laughed, I missed my mom, I remembered my grandma, I reconnected with old friends, I talked to Yosh, I drank coffee, I listened to music, I wrote a song, and I changed my Discord status from Invisible to Active.

None of those things happened because I was trying to move on.

They happened because I was simply living.

On Day 1, the very first thing I did after waking up was check my phone... hoping.

Today, I still check my phone first. But now it's for messages from friends. Work. Discord. Random conversations. Life.

The action stayed the same. The reason changed.



Today's Weight: 7/10

Not a perfect day. But a real one. I worked. I rested. I grieved. I laughed. I reconnected. I wrote. I became visible again.

Some days aren't meant to be rated by how much you achieved. Some days are meant to be measured by how present you were.

Today, I was present.

Songs of Day 7

- **Sparkle** — RADWIMPS
- **In My Place** — Coldplay (YouTube knew)
- **How Many Hours** — Michael Learns to Rock
- **NoThingz** — full playlist
- **We Used To Talk Every Day** — my own lyrics



On Day 1, I started building again because I had to.

Today, I simply woke up, lived an ordinary Tuesday, and realized somewhere along the way that forward no longer felt like something I had to force.

It just felt natural.

— *Ralph*.

